Luke speaks. | The CareLeaders

Keynotes and conference workshops

Seven keynotes with Luke Rodgers BEM.

Story-led, practical talks for foster carers, social workers, schools, senior leaders, employers and care-experienced young people. 45 to 90 minutes, in person or online.

45+
keynotes since the start of 2024

30 to 400
people in the room, from team away days to national conferences

4,000+
delegates expected since 2024, from organisers' booking numbers



Meet Luke

From care leaver to care leader.

“I went into care at 10. At 15 I was living in a B&B, and at 18 I was in a caravan. I gave my first keynote at 19, standing in front of a room of professionals and telling them what care had felt like from the inside. I’ve been doing it ever since, because it’s still one of the fastest ways I know to change how people see children in care.

That’s why I set up The Care Leaders: to go from care leaver to care leader, and to help others make the same move. Since then I’ve led the national engagement on England’s new fostering standards, been a Knowledge Equity Fellow at Saïd Business School, Oxford, and been awarded the British Empire Medal. Every talk brings together my story, the theory behind it and tools your audience can use the next day.”

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4,000+
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400
people in the largest single room so far

Luke at a glance

British Empire Medal
Awarded in 2018.

Knowledge Equity Fellow
Saïd Business School, University of Oxford.

National leadership
Engagement lead on England’s new fostering standards.

Spoken at
Community Care Live, the Local Government Association, NAVSH national conferences, and online to audiences in Australia.

Choose a talk

Seven talks, one spine.

Every talk follows the same spine: Luke's story, the theory behind it, and tools people can use straight away. Talks run from 45 to 90 minutes, in person or online.

Not sure which fits? Tell us about your audience and we'll recommend one, or build one for you.

Story **Theory** **Action**



Mixed audiences

Living a Careless Life



Foster carers

Just Say Yes



Social workers

The Power of the Profile



Schools and colleges

Tools for Schools



Senior leaders

Lived Experience Leadership



Care-experienced young people

From Care Leaver to Care Leader



Employers

Be the First Yes



The flagship talk

Living a Careless Life

For mixed audiences

My flagship keynote. Story-led and upbeat, it shows what the adults who made a difference actually did, and gives people practical tools to take back to the children they work with.

Delegates leave with a workbook built around the talk, and 12 months of the full keynote film and a self-paced online course on The Care Leaders Online.

Also runs as a 90-minute training session.



For foster carers

Just Say Yes

Seeing the child behind the referral. What behaviour is really communicating, trauma and attachment in plain language, and simple tools that help carers say yes with understanding.



For social workers

The Power of the Profile

One day, the child will read what you wrote. What it feels like to read your own records, and how to write honest, balanced and hopeful profiles that help other adults say yes.



For schools and colleges

Tools for Schools

How to read the messages in children's behaviour and respond with the right tools: language and stigma, attachment and trauma, and where school and children's social care clash.

Also runs as a twilight session for a whole staff team.



For senior leaders

Lived Experience Leadership

How professional leaders can work alongside people with lived experience, so they're recognised as leaders and not only for their story.



For care-experienced young people

From Care Leaver to Care Leader

Your story as a strength, not a setback. My journey from care to national leadership, and how adversity builds real leadership skills.



For employers

Be the First Yes

Care-experienced people are the biggest untapped potential in the UK. The barriers they face in jobs, education and homes, and how your organisation can be the first to say yes.

More than a keynote

Every booking comes with the same five things.

In person or online, so the learning doesn't stop when the session ends.

1

Before the event

A planning call

We talk through your audience, your theme and what you want people to leave with, and shape the keynote around it.

You get

- A 30-minute planning call
- The keynote shaped around your audience and theme
- A title and blurb for your programme, plus Luke's photo and bio

2

Up to 90 minutes

The keynote

One of seven keynotes, or one built for you. Luke's story opens it, the theory underneath gives it rigour, and the room leaves with something to do differently. In person or live online.

You get

- A keynote of up to 90 minutes
- Time for questions and discussion
- The slides, so you can share them with delegates

3

Story, Theory, Action

A workbook for every delegate

A printed or digital workbook built around the keynote, with activities that help delegates take the learning back into their teams.

You get

- A workbook per delegate, print-ready or digital
- Activities for individuals and teams
- Your logo on the cover on request

4

On The Care Leaders Online

The recording, for 12 months

Every delegate can watch the full keynote again for 12 months after your event, and share it with colleagues who could not attend.

You get

- The full keynote recorded
- 12 months' access for every delegate
- A link you can put in your follow-up email

5

What happens next

Follow-up

A short conversation after the event about what landed, and what training or support would carry it on, if you want it. No obligation.

You get

- A follow-up call if you want one
- Delegate feedback, where we gathered it
- Options for training, programmes or a return visit



What people say

Nothing was as transformative as hearing Luke speak about his life.

Dr Janet Rose
Principal, Norland College

I have seen them in action at many conferences and have heard professionals report changes in their own behaviour.

Professor Judy Sebba
Rees Centre, University of Oxford

You demand bravery and humanity in equal measure.

Maggie Atkinson
Former Children's Commissioner for England

The CareLeaders

How booking works

Book Luke for your event.

1 Tell us about your event

The date, your audience and whether you're after a keynote, a workshop or both.

2 Get availability and a fee

Luke's availability, the fee and the talk we'd recommend for your audience. If Luke is free, we hold the date for 14 days.

3 Confirm by email

Reply to confirm and send a purchase order if your organisation uses them. Our booking terms come with the email.

4 Before the day

A short call to shape the talk around your audience, and a checklist of what Luke needs on the day.

hello@thecareleaders.com · 0800 233 5597

We reply within 3 working days.

Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award, iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026.
Children & Young People Now Workforce Development Award 2023.

Keynotes are contracted and invoiced by Luke Speaks Ltd, company number 15452230, powered by The Care Leaders

